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| <b>CONTACT INFORMATION</b>       | Department of Political Science<br>Stanford University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | maemac@stanford.edu<br>www.maemacdonald.com |
| <b>EDUCATION</b>                 | <b>Stanford University</b> Stanford, CA 2021–2027 (expected)<br>Ph.D., Department of Political Science <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Committee: James D. Fearon (co-chair), Jeremy Weinstein (co-chair), Judith Goldstein (on leave), Jens Hainmueller, and Michael Allen</li> <li>Knight-Hennessy Scholar</li> </ul> <b>University of Oxford</b> Oxford, UK 2015–2018<br>B.A., Philosophy, Politics, and Economics ( <i>Double First Class</i> )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                             |
| <b>RESEARCH INTERESTS</b>        | International political economy; international security; forced displacement and migration; foreign aid and development; international organizations; violence; Africa.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                             |
| <b>PUBLICATIONS</b>              | Lisa Blaydes, James D. Fearon, and <b>Mae MacDonald</b> . 2025. “ <a href="#">Understanding Intimate Partner Violence</a> .” <i>Annual Review of Political Science</i> 28:351–374.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                             |
| <b>WORKING PAPERS</b>            | <b>Mae MacDonald</b> . “Peace or Push? Understanding Global Patterns of Refugee Return.” <i>Job market paper</i> .<br><b>Mae MacDonald</b> . “Aid Cuts and the Politics of Refugee Hosting.” <i>Immigration Policy Lab Working Paper Series</i> . Under review.<br>Sigrid Weber, <b>Mae MacDonald</b> , Adam Lichtenheld, Jessica Wolff, Alex Wendo, Annet Adong, Clare Clingain, David Musiime, Andrew Zeitlin, and Jens Hainmueller. “Does Building Business Networks Strengthen Refugee Economic and Social Integration?”<br><b>Mae MacDonald</b> and Adam Lichtenheld. “Beyond Encampment? Understanding Attitudes Toward Refugee Integration.” <i>Immigration Policy Lab Working Paper Series</i> . Under review.<br><b>Mae MacDonald</b> , Alexander Yeandle, Ryan Jablonski, and Brigitte Seim. “Partisanship and Blame Attribution for Foreign Aid Cuts in the Global South.” |                                             |
| <b>WORKS IN PROGRESS</b>         | <b>Mae MacDonald</b> . “Cooperation with the International Refugee Regime.” <i>Book project</i> .<br><b>Mae MacDonald</b> . “U.S. Foreign Policy Shocks and Attitudes Toward Great Powers.”                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                             |
| <b>POLICY AND PUBLIC WRITING</b> | <b>Mae MacDonald</b> , Adam Lichtenheld, and Tolossa Asrat. 2025. “ <a href="#">Kenya Embraces Refugee Integration – and Citizens Are on Board</a> .” <i>The New Humanitarian</i> . Reprinted in <i>The EastAfrican</i> , a Kenyan newspaper.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                             |

**Mae MacDonald.** 2025. “Rapid Response Evidence: Tracking the Impact of US Aid Cuts in Kakuma Refugee Camp.” Policy Brief for UN Refugee Agency.

**Mae MacDonald.** 2024. “Tackling Small Boats and Building Global Resilience: A Twofold Policy Plan on Refugees.” Policy Brief commissioned by the UK Cabinet Office, King’s College London Centre for Grand Strategy.

## AWARDS AND HONORS

**Centennial Teaching Assistant Award**, Stanford University 2026  
Award recognizing outstanding teaching assistants at Stanford.

**Diversifying Academia, Recruiting Excellence (DARE) Fellow**, Stanford University 2025  
Competitive (1 year) full-tuition graduate fellowship for students who will diversify the professoriate.

**Ric Weiland Graduate Fellow**, Stanford University 2024  
Award to 20 exceptional Ph.D. students across the Humanities & Sciences.

**Carnegie International Policy Fellow**, Johns Hopkins University 2024  
Fellowship and network for scholars at the intersection of policy and research.

**Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education (EDGE) Fellow**, Stanford University 2021  
Competitive graduate fellowship for early-stage students from underrepresented backgrounds.

**Knight-Hennessy Scholar**, Stanford University 2021  
Competitive (3 year) full-tuition graduate fellowship (similar to the Rhodes Scholarship in the UK).

**YouGov Fellowship**, University of Oxford 2018  
Award for graduate and undergraduate students to conduct their dissertation research through YouGov’s survey platform.

**E.T. Warner Prize for Excellence in Philosophy, Politics, and Economics**, University of Oxford 2018  
Award for academic excellence in P.P.E. at Christ Church college.

**Academic Scholar**, University of Oxford 2016  
Award for academic merit following first-year examinations.

**Crankstart Scholar**, University of Oxford 2015  
Award for undergraduate students from lower-income households.

## GRANTS

**Stanford School of Humanities & Sciences GRO (\$5,495)** 2026

**J-PAL/IPA Displaced Livelihoods Initiative (\$60,000)** 2024  
with Jeremy Weinstein and Adam Lichtenheld

**Stanford Institute for Economics Policy Research (\$5,200)** 2024

**Ric Weiland Graduate Fellowship (\$4,000)** 2024

**King Center on Global Development (\$25,000)** 2023  
with Jeremy Weinstein and Adam Lichtenheld

**J-PAL/IPA Displaced Livelihoods Initiative (\$10,000)** 2023

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|                                    | <b>Freeman Spogli Institute for International Studies</b> (\$9,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2023      |
|                                    | <b>Stanford Europe Center</b> (\$1,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2023      |
|                                    | <b>King Center on Global Development</b> (\$5,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2023      |
|                                    | <b>Sohaib and Sara Abbasi Program in Islamic Studies</b> (\$3,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2023      |
|                                    | <b>Stanford Impact Labs</b> (\$4,000)<br>with Jens Hainmueller                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2022      |
|                                    | <b>King Center on Global Development</b> (\$8,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 2022      |
|                                    | <b>Stanford Institute for Research in the Social Sciences</b> (\$1,500)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2022      |
|                                    | <b>Stanford EDGE</b> (\$6,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2021      |
|                                    | <b>YouGov Fellowship</b> (\$12,000)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2018      |
| <b>PROFESSIONAL<br/>EXPERIENCE</b> | <b>Movement on the Ground</b> , Refugee Camp Volunteer, Greece                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2021      |
|                                    | <b>YouGov</b> , Graduate Researcher (Public Sector), UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2018–2019 |
|                                    | <b>CalAid</b> , Refugee Camp Volunteer, Greece                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 2017      |
|                                    | <b>The Entrepreneurial Refugee Network</b> , Intern, UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2017      |
|                                    | <b>Global Policy Institute</b> , Research Intern, UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2017      |
|                                    | <b>Political Party</b> , Intern, UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2015      |
|                                    | <b>House of Commons</b> , Intern, UK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2014      |
| <b>TEACHING</b>                    | <b>Teaching Assistant</b> , Stanford University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |           |
|                                    | • Introduction to International Relations (James D. Fearon), Fall 2024                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |           |
|                                    | • War and Peace in American Foreign Policy (Kenneth Schultz), Spring 2024                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |           |
|                                    | • Introduction to International Relations (James D. Fearon), Fall 2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |           |
|                                    | <b>Class Co-Coordinator</b> , Stanford University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |           |
|                                    | • Climate Displacement, Migration, and Mobility (Chris Field), Spring 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |           |
|                                    | <b>Research Assistant (RA) Supervision</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |           |
| <b>DATASETS</b>                    | • Policy Research Internship Supervisor (31 RAs), <a href="#">University of California Washington Program</a> with the Political Violence Lab, 2025–2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                |           |
|                                    | • Undergraduate Research Supervisor (3 RAs), Stanford IRiSS Research Assistant Internship Program, 2023–2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |           |
|                                    | • Undergraduate Research Supervisor (2 RAs), Stanford University, 2023–present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |           |
|                                    | <b>Global Refugee Return (GRR) Dataset.</b> Original dataset of all protracted refugee situations (293 origin–asylum dyads; 1980–2023) that corrects errors in UNHCR stock and repatriation figures, and introduces new indicators of <i>de facto</i> asylum conditions and forced return practices. Coded with the help of 36 research assistants. <i>Forthcoming.</i> |           |
|                                    | <b>UNHCR Funding Dataset.</b> Donor-level contributions to the UN Refugee Agency and country-level allocation of expenditures within recipient countries. <i>Forthcoming.</i>                                                                                                                                                                                           |           |

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| <b>TALKS AND<br/>CONFERENCES</b>     | <p><b>Scheduled:</b> Peace Science Society (International) Annual Meeting.</p> <p><b>2026:</b> American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting; On-line Peace Science Colloquium; Yale Research Initiative on Innovation &amp; Scale (Y-RISE) International Conference on Migration and Development; World Bank-UNHCR Joint Data Center on Forced Displacement Research Conference; Berlin Meeting on the Political Economy of Development (MoPED); Berkeley-Stanford IPE Colloquium; Immigration Policy Lab Workshop; APSA Dissertation Workshop Series (Migration and Citizenship); Stanford International Affairs Society.</p> <p><b>2025:</b> American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting; World Bank-UNHCR Joint Data Center on Forced Displacement Research Conference; Forced Displacement Working Group (FDWG), Penn Development Research Initiative; Immigration Policy Lab Workshop.</p> <p><b>2024:</b> American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting; International Studies Association (ISA); APSA Migration &amp; Citizenship Section Dissertation Workshop; UNHCR-IPA Evidence in Action: Displaced Livelihoods Initiative in Africa; Immigration Policy Lab Workshop.</p> |
| <b>PROFESSIONAL<br/>AFFILIATIONS</b> | <p><b>Immigration Policy Lab</b>, Stanford University</p> <p><b>Forced Displacement Working Group</b>, Penn Development Research Initiative (PDRI-DevLab), University of Pennsylvania</p> <p><b>Centre for Grand Strategy</b>, War Studies Department, King's College London</p> <p><b>Carnegie International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network (IPSCON)</b>, Henry A. Kissinger Center for Global Affairs, Johns Hopkins University</p> <p><b>Political Violence Lab</b>, University of California Merced</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>SERVICE</b>                       | <p><b>Reviewer</b><br/><i>Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Immigrant &amp; Refugee Studies</i></p> <p><b>Mentorship</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Refugee-Led Research Hub (East Africa), 2023</li> <li>• Young African Research Network (YARN), 2024</li> <li>• Stanford Political Science Pathways to PhD, 2023</li> <li>• Stanford IRiSS Research Assistant Internship Program, 2023-2024</li> <li>• Stanford First Year Graduate Student Mentor, 2023</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>SKILLS AND<br/>FIELDWORK</b>      | <p><b>Computing:</b> R, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Python, QGIS, Google Earth Engine (GEE)</p> <p><b>Fieldwork:</b> Kenya (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025); Uganda (2022, 2023); Thailand (2022); Greece (2017, 2021); UK (2017)</p> <p><b>Additional training:</b> Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University (2023)</p> <p><b>Languages:</b> English (native); French (intermediate)</p> <p><b>Archives:</b> UNHCR (2023)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |